

film festival Mixed Double

DELHI Come July 20, the usually placid Siri Fort Auditorium will buzz like a frenzied film multiplex as Osian's Cinefan Festival of Arab and Asian Cinema, the annual cinema extravaganza returns to the city in its ninth edition with 120-plus films. Debutant Navdeep Singh directs Abhay Deol in his noir tribute, *Manorama Six Feet Under*, while Rajat Kapoor, emboldened by the success of *Mixed Doubles*, returns with *The Imposter Who Wasn't (Mithya)*.

Greenhorn director Arindam Mitra's cricket adaptation of T.S. Eliot's *Murder in the Cathedral* stars K.K. Menon and warhorse Danny Denzongpa stars in his 150th feature, debutant Shivajee Chandrabhasan's *Frozen*. There's also *Omkara* and *Honeymoon Travels Pvt Ltd*.

This year's festival will also screen films at PVR Plaza and Rivoli. Says Osian's founder-chairman Neville Tuli about this new, **Navdeep Singh's *Manorama Six Feet Under***

business-like face of the festival, "We need to bridge the divide between the so-called commercial and art cinema through such festivals. This means drawing mainstream producers who until now were wary of a bad review at a film festival killing their film even before it hit the cinema halls."

Being the year of Indo-Japanese friendship, the festival will feature five special sections on the country's culture and history. The tribute to master filmmaker Kenji Mizoguchi, to be inaugurated with a live *benshi* narrative to his *The Water Magician* on July 21, will be the centerpiece. Five samurai films and a selection of contemporary cinema will provide a glimpse of Japan old and new. *Hymns of Freedom* will commemorate the 150th anniversary of the Mutiny of 1857 with tales of struggle from Asia and the Arab world. The inaugural Filmcraft, showcasing and debating aspects of film practice, will look at cinematography with Mani Kaul. The First Features section will see Anand Rai's *Strangers* as the sole Indian entry. Film faithful, bow down. **by Gaurav Rajkhowa**



music

Exchanging Notes

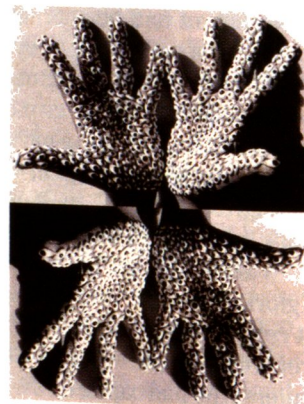
CHENNAI Fiddlers on the Hoof, a music production company from the UK, is touring India this month with 'Musical Express' to promote musical exchange between amateur and professional artistes of both the countries. Comprising singers Sheelagh Greer, Judith Sheridan and Sunil Paulraj, the group performs regularly in India with local musicians at varied venues, from churches to stadiums. The instrumentalists from London will be supported by local musicians playing solos, duets and ensembles from popular West End and Broadway musicals. A choir of over 100 Indian schoolchildren and 10 professional dancers will perform with them. In the pipeline is a co-production by British and Indian teenagers which will tour both the countries. On July 14 at Music Academy, Chennai, and on July 17 at Chowdaiah Memorial Hall, Bangalore. **by Nirmala Ravindran**

Fiddlers get vocal in India



art Natural Ware

DELHI Nature Morte, India's premier gallery for post-modern and installation art, presents new works by Samit Das, Anita Dube, Seher Shah and Raqs Media Collective. They will showcase installations, architectural structures and mixed media on paper including works in stark black and white, all coming together in a tactile and visual journey through



A work by Dube space and landscapes. At A-1, Neeti Bagh from July 2-28, Monday to Saturday.